Professional Portfolio — Artifact 3

Rahmat Zada

Indiana Wesleyan University

July 2026

Overview

The final thing I choose to include into my portfolio is my Prompt Engineering exercise, a practical class project where I built, tested, and polished prompts for a generative AI tool to do a given job. The second category, AI/ML Professional skills Self-Assessment, is my capacity to assess my abilities in a critical and honest way. This artifact, the AI/ML historical history, and the self-assessment round up the portfolio. The history is my understanding of the background of the issue, the self-assessment is how I measure my own talent and this exercise is what that skill looks like when applied to a real problem" (Byrum, 2022).

Selected artifact: Prompt engineering exercise

In this little project I built a generative AI model, provided some instructions for it, tested it and then changed the instructions based on the outcomes. What you're seeing in my final submission is the original prompt I gave, the framework replies, my complaints of what was missing in the outputs, and the new prompts I came up with to fill in the missing sections. I picked this artifact because this project is an example of rapid engineering, a field I suggested for further experience in my self-assessment (Goldberg et al., 2026).

Audience and purpose

This artifact is for a technical team lead or prospective employer who would rather see examples of my work with artificial intelligence (AI) technologies than read about it on my CV. My self evaluation indicates what abilities I believe I have and this artifact demonstrates my thought process for a particular set of questions so the reader may judge the conclusions for themselves. Instead of just posting the completed piece I saved a lot of the initial prompts and tweaks to show how the work changed from an underwhelming first try.

Project description

We had to utilize a generative AI program to complete the experiment, write down our actions and then work out how to improve it. I began with a simple query, considered the response, then looked for the places where the directions were vague or where the outcome didn't really match the nature of the task. I then re-wrote the prompt to include more detailed needs, additional background information, and relevant examples. I kept doing this until the outcome was consistently good enough. The hardest part was not to choose the first practical solution. Developing the skill was spending the time to find out why an output was not good enough.

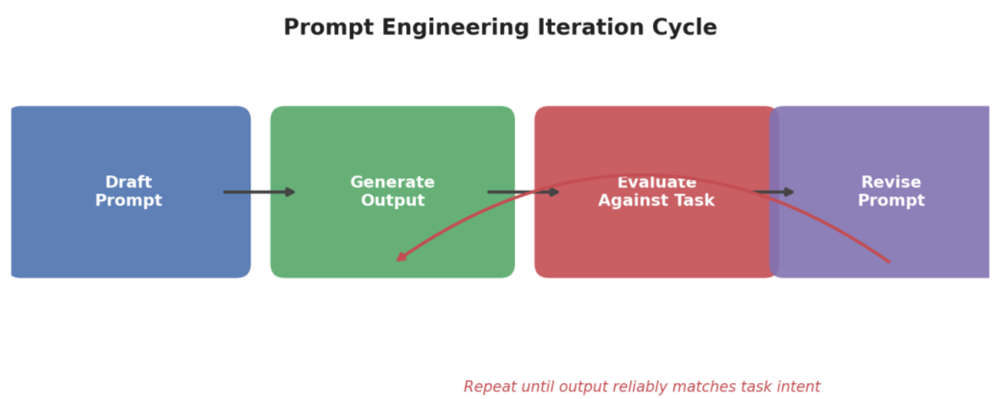

Figure 1. The iterative cycle used to draft, test, and refine prompts.

Skills demonstrated

In this similar strategy, the output of the task was evaluated according to criteria. This method allowed for speedy engineering and evaluation of functional models. Also relevant is the competence of AI ethics and responsible use, since the prompts were revised analyzing the validity and bias of the results, instead of accepting them at face value. This artifact is an example of the systematic incremental practice I've been doing to enhance my prompt engineering abilities, in which I previously ranked lower in areas such as AI ethics (Goldberg et al, 2026).

Reflection

This artifact has allowed me to look at response writing as a process and not as a talent that demands a gut feeling. It's easier to create a prompt, receive a mediocre response, and move on, than it is to sit with a lousy answer and try to suss out which particular command was missing. I attempted to do the same with my self-evaluation, where I had to provide real examples to back each grade, not just generic opinions. Not only tried again, detected failure. I'd want to have the same approach, moving forward: not just what I accomplished, but what proof might someone else find that I was effective at it?

References

Byrum, J. (2022). AI in financial portfolio management: Practical considerations and use cases. In Innovative Technology at the Interface of Finance and Operations: Volume I (pp. 249–270). Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Goldberg, D. M., Sobo, E. J., Collins, K. K., Martin, A. S., Hauze, S. W., & Frazee, J. P. (2026). Advancing Generative AI Literacy Through a Faculty-Focused Micro-Credential. Journal of Information Systems Education, 37(2), 306–322.